Weekly Bulletin of IT News and Articles

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CIS NEWS

1. Astana Hub now hosts almost 400 female-led startups: a closer look at the technologies they are building

(Digitalbusiness.kz)

The number of female-led startups within the Astana Hub innovation cluster continues its steady climb. While the community began 2023 with 179 such companies, that figure grew to 250 in 2024 and 301 in 2025. Today, there are 395 startups headed by women. Behind these numbers are dedicated teams and tech solutions reshaping sectors from healthcare and education to sports and public safety.

Among the standout projects is AR Sana, a HealthTech startup led by Ainur Nuradil. The team is developing a digital early-intervention system for speech therapy targeting children aged 1.5 to 6 years.

The platform combines a gamified module for children with professional analytical tools for speech therapists. This hybrid approach ensures therapy continues between in-person sessions while allowing specialists to track progress seamlessly. To date, AR Sana is being tested by over 20 families and is utilized by 5 speech therapy centers, 2 schools, and more than 35 specialists. The project recently secured a 10 million tenge grant from the NU Impact Foundation and is currently preparing for regional scaling.

Tota Smatova, founder of CheckDoc, is focused on making healthcare more accessible through digital integration. It is a comprehensive platform that centralizes lab testing, doctor consultations, and home-based medical visits into a single app. One of its hallmark features is an AI-driven triage consultant that collects patient history and records complaints, providing preliminary recommendations and a list of required tests before the patient even sees a doctor.

In its 3.5 years of operation, the service has served over 4,000 patients and 10 corporate clients, attracting approximately $ 300,000 in private and venture capital.

Kazakhstani startups are also making waves in the world of high-performance athletics. Mirai Tech, a DeepTech startup, leverages artificial intelligence to analyze athlete biometrics and movement. Their solutions are designed to mitigate injury risks and optimize training efficiency.

Founded by Gulnur Kalimuldina, the project secured $ 200,000 in private investment and won the prestigious Astana Hub Battle at Digital Bridge 2025. Kalimuldina's impact has gained global recognition, earning her a spot in the Top 30 global female founders list by the international Aurora Tech Award.

Public safety is the core mission of AMAN, a startup founded by Aruzhan Mede. The team has built an ecosystem for both digital and physical security for children and

educational institutions. Their mobile app features an SOS button that transmits real-time geolocation and audio feeds to guardians.

For educational facilities, they developed AMAN AI, a sophisticated system integrating AI-video analytics and IoT sensors that send emergency alerts directly to police departments. With a response time of just 4 seconds, the app has been downloaded over 20,000 times, serving more than 3,500 families and 15 schools.

In the dental sector, MacDent is leading the charge with a SaaS + AI cloud platform designed to automate clinic workflows. The service handles everything from digital patient records and scheduling to financial accounting and deep analytics.

The platform is currently used by over 2,000 clinics and is expanding across Central Asia, including Uzbekistan and Kyrgyzstan. Founder Makpal Orakkyzy, a finalist at the 2025 Astana Hub Battle, was also named a winner at the Women in Tech Global Awards 2025 in Paris.

Aidana Aituarova, founder of Porte Tech, is revolutionizing the guest experience. Her startup provides a "digital concierge" service that allows hotel guests to check in online, use their smartphones as room keys, and order services without ever visiting the reception desk.

According to Astana Hub, the project grew tenfold over the past year. Beyond Kazakhstan, Porte Tech has begun deploying its solutions in Saudi Arabia and Uzbekistan.

The steady rise of female-led startups at Astana Hub highlights a dynamic maturation of the region's tech ecosystem. By effectively leveraging advanced technologies to solve complex, real-world problems, from healthcare and child safety to enterprise automation, these female founders are moving beyond local success to secure international funding, earn global awards, and scale their solutions worldwide.

(Read full article at https://digitalbusiness.kz/2026-03-05/v-astana-hub-uzhe-395-startapov-pod-rukovodstvom-zhenshchin-kakie-tehnologii-oni-sozdayut/)

2. European AI startup secures investment from Kazakhstan-based EA Ventures

(Digitalbusiness.kz)

EA Ventures Plug and Play EMEA Fund, a venture fund with Kazakhstani roots, has announced a strategic investment in Kalipso.ai. The startup joins the fund's expanding international portfolio.

Kalipso.ai is developing an enterprise AI solution designed to automate regulatory compliance. The platform identifies applicable regulatory requirements, maps them against a company's products and services, highlights documentation gaps, and suggests necessary remediations. By streamlining these complex processes, Kalipso.ai significantly reduces operational risks and manual labor for legal and compliance departments. The platform currently covers European Union directives and national

regulations, featuring a database that is updated daily – a critical feature for firms operating across international markets.

The investment follows a rigorous selection process. In 2025, the EA Ventures team evaluated 3,075 applications from startups worldwide. After conducting deep-dive analyses into 655 projects, the fund ultimately provided financing to only five companies, including Kalipso.ai.

EA Ventures' investment in Kalipso.ai highlights the critical market need for AI-driven compliance tools capable of navigating complex, constantly changing regulatory landscapes like the European Union. Furthermore, Kalipso.ai's ability to secure financing from a highly competitive pool of over 3,000 global applicants strongly validates the operational value and commercial potential of its technology.

(Read full article at https://digitalbusiness.kz/2026-03-03/ii-startap-iz-evropi-poluchil-investitsii-ot-kazahstanskogo-fonda-ea-ventures/)

3. Global use of generative AI continues to rise; Kazakhstan leads adoption in Central Asia

(The Astana Times)

Global adoption of generative artificial intelligence *(AI)* continued to grow in the second half of 2025, rising by 1.2%, compared with the first half of the year, with roughly one in six people worldwide now using generative AI tools, according to analysis released by the Microsoft AI Economy Institute.

Researchers track AI diffusion as the share of people who have used a generative AI product during a given period. The institute continues refining its methodology to better measure how adoption varies across countries and how it contributes to priorities such as scientific discovery and productivity gains.

The report shows that countries that invested early in digital infrastructure, AI skills development and government adoption remain global leaders.

The United Arab Emirates ranks first worldwide, with 64% of its working-age population using AI by the end of 2025, up from 59.4% earlier in the year. The country now leads second-ranked Singapore by more than 3%, with Singapore reporting 60.9% adoption.

High adoption levels were also recorded in Norway *(46.4%)*, Ireland *(44.6%)*, France *(44%)*, Spain *(41.8%)*, New Zealand *(40.5%)*, as well as the United Kingdom and the Netherlands *(both 38.9%)* and Qatar *(38.3%)*.

Among countries in Central Asia and the Eurasian Economic Union, Kazakhstan ranked first in AI adoption.

In the second half of 2025, 13.7% of the country's working-age population used generative AI tools. Other countries in the region reported lower adoption rates, including Belarus *(8.4%)*, the Kyrgyz Republic *(8.2%)* and Russia *(8%).*

Meanwhile, Armenia, Uzbekistan, Tajikistan and Turkmenistan were among the regional countries with the lowest levels of AI diffusion.

Similarly, low levels of AI use, around 5.6%, are observed in Turkmenistan, Tajikistan and Afghanistan. Experts attribute these differences primarily to varying levels of investment in digital infrastructure, education and regulatory frameworks.

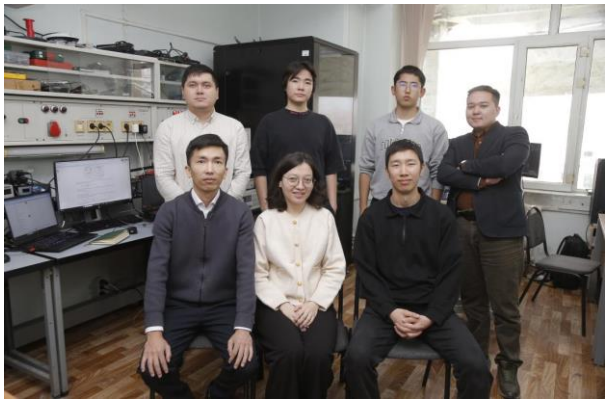
Generative AI adoption is growing globally, but it is heavily stratified by systemic technological readiness. Nations that prioritize and invest heavily in digital infrastructure and education, such as the UAE and Singapore, are dominating adoption rates. Meanwhile, regions that lack these foundational investments continue to lag significantly, though countries like Kazakhstan prove that targeted regional focus can foster localized growth within emerging markets.

(Read full article at https://astanatimes.com/2026/03/global-use-of-generative-ai-continues-to-rise-kazakhstan-leads-adoption-in-central-asia/)

4. Kazakh scientists develop technology to generate electricity from noise

(The Times of Central Asia)

Researchers at Satbayev University in Almaty, led by project leader Albanbay Nurtay, are developing a compact electromagnetic converter designed to harvest environmental mechanical vibrations and transform them into a stable source of electrical energy. This engineering project specifically targets the frequency range of tens to a few hundred hertz, the spectrum most commonly found in natural and industrial oscillations, to provide autonomous power for Internet of Things *(IoT)* sensors operating in remote or hard-to-access areas. The device utilizes the law of electromagnetic induction, generating an electrical signal through the relative motion of internal coils and magnets. Currently, the team is progressing through the initial phases of conceptual 3D and mathematical modeling, with a focus on maximizing conversion efficiency and minimizing energy loss across variable vibration conditions. Future stages of the project include the construction of experimental prototypes and a dedicated testing platform to refine the technical characteristics of the hardware before filing for intellectual property patents.



This project represents a critical breakthrough for Kazakhstan's digital infrastructure, specifically addressing the "power bottleneck" that often limits the deployment of large-scale IoT networks in geographically isolated regions. By converting ambient physical oscillations into a reliable, maintenance-free energy stream, Satbayev University is providing the hardware foundation necessary for continuous industrial and environmental monitoring. This advancement is a vital step toward sustainable "green" technology, as it enables the long-term operation of autonomous sensors that feed essential data into AI-driven analytics systems without the logistical challenges of battery replacement or traditional grid connectivity.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/kazakh-scientists-develop-technology-to-generate-electricity-from-noise/#:~:text=Kazakh%20Scientists%20Develop%20Technology%20to,Science)

5. Almaty hosts ranking business day discussion on whether E-commerce could become Kazakhstan's "New Oil"

(The Times of Central Asia)

During the inaugural Ranking Business Day held in Almaty, industry experts and government officials analyzed the transformative surge of Kazakhstan's e-commerce sector, which reached a valuation of $ 6.4 billion in 2024. This 29% year-over-year growth signals a profound shift where digital marketplaces are evolving beyond simple sales channels into sophisticated IT ecosystems that seamlessly integrate fintech payments, automated logistics, and digital marketing services. For the country's small and medium-sized businesses, which account for 90% of marketplace sales and 40% of the national GDP, these platforms provide essential, ready-made IT infrastructure that eliminates the need for individual companies to invest in proprietary technology stacks or complex logistics networks. The fiscal impact of this digitalization is substantial, with the fintech-centric leader Kaspi.kz contributing $ 276 million in taxes in 2025, followed by international platforms Wildberries and Ozon. Looking toward future technological integration, Kazpost is reportedly finalizing a partnership with a major Chinese marketplace to create a new joint trading platform, while Wildberries is exploring the acquisition of a Kazakh financial organization to further embed fintech capabilities into its commerce department.

The transition of e-commerce into Kazakhstan's "new oil" reflects a strategic pivot toward a data-driven, rather than resource-dependent, economy. By providing the primary IT scaffolding for the nation's entrepreneurial class, marketplaces have become the central nervous system of domestic trade, effectively industrializing the tech sector through massive scale and high-frequency digital transactions. However, as the government debates new consumer protection laws and mandates for foreign platforms to integrate local manufacturers, the next phase of this evolution will likely be defined by a push for digital sovereignty, requiring a balance between open-market international partnerships and the protection of local technological and manufacturing interests.

(Read full article at https://timesca.com/almaty-hosts-ranking-business-day-discussion-on-whether-e-commerce-could-become-kazakhstans-new-oil/)

GLOBAL NEWS

6. New lawsuit challenges Rubio's threats against foreign tech regulators

(The New York Times)

On March 9, 2026, the Coalition for Independent Technology Research, represented by the Knight First Amendment Institute, filed a federal lawsuit against the Trump administration and Secretary of State Marco Rubio over a controversial visa ban policy. The administration's directive explicitly targets foreign technology researchers, data scientists, and trust & safety professionals who study algorithmic amplification, online disinformation, and hate speech on social media platforms.

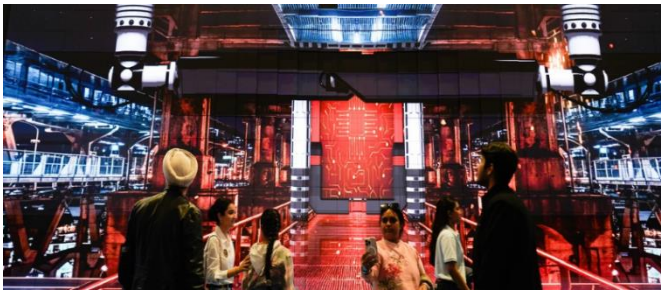
The State Department claims the policy is necessary to dismantle a "global censorship-industrial complex" and protect conservative speech online, having already weaponized the ban against prominent European tech regulators and advocates following their decision to fine Elon Musk's social media company X under the EU's Digital Services Act. However, the plaintiffs argue the policy is unconstitutional viewpoint discrimination. By threatening noncitizen tech experts with visa revocation and deportation, the lawsuit warns that the U.S. government is actively dismantling critical IT research networks, chilling the study of artificial intelligence and social media algorithms, and severely damaging the American technology sector's ability to govern digital platforms safely.

This lawsuit highlights a critical intersection where immigration policy is being actively weaponized to dictate global technology governance. By systematically punishing the IT professionals and data researchers who analyze algorithmic harm and develop content moderation frameworks, the administration is attempting to legally enforce its preferred digital ecosystem. This creates a deeply hostile environment for the international tech community, threatening to derail global collaboration on AI safety, digital trust, and the scientific study of social media manipulation.

(Read full article at https://www.nytimes.com/2026/03/09/us/politics/lawsuit-rubio-social-media.html

7. India budget paved way for tech investment with tax certainty

(Bloomberg)



India's Union Budget 2026–27 introduces sweeping tax reforms strategically designed to position the country as a highly competitive global hub for cloud computing, AI infrastructure, and advanced electronics manufacturing. The budget addresses historical tax risks that have deterred foreign investors, specifically the risk of triggering "permanent establishment" and resulting tax disputes when deploying servers or capital equipment in India.

Key tech-focused measures include:

Data Center Tax Holiday: A tax holiday until March 31, 2047, for eligible foreign companies procuring services from India-based data centers to serve overseas customers, alongside a predictable 15% safe-harbor transfer pricing margin for related parties.

Exemptions for Electronics Manufacturing: A five-year tax holiday *(through 2030-31)* for nonresident entities supplying high-value tooling and capital equipment to Indian contract manufacturers, easing the development of the semiconductor and electronics supply chain.

Talent Mobility Relief: A five-year tax exemption on global income for specialized nonresident professionals *(e.g., fab design engineers, AI experts)* visiting India to work under specified government schemes.

With its 2026–27 budget, the Indian government has recognized that regulatory clarity is just as critical as financial incentives in the global race for tech supremacy. By explicitly removing the ambiguity around permanent establishment exposure for data centers and semiconductor manufacturing, India is offering foreign BigTech and advanced hardware companies the long-term, decades-long tax certainty required to safely deploy massive capital and highly skilled human talent into the country's rapidly expanding AI and digital infrastructure ecosystem.

(Read full article at https://news.bloombergtax.com/daily-tax-report-international/india-budget-paved-way-for-tech-investment-with-tax-certainty)

8. Tax relief for remote IT workers in Ireland

(Enterprise.gov.ie)

On March 5, 2026, the Irish government published a statutory review of the Work Life Balance and Miscellaneous Provisions Act 2023, revealing that the legislative framework for remote work is functioning effectively with a 94% approval rate for employee requests. Despite the high success rate and low administrative burden for businesses, the review identified a critical gap in awareness, particularly among rural communities. To solidify Ireland's position as a competitive, "future-focused" business environment, the government is coupling this legislative success with significant IT and digital infrastructure investments, including:

Connectivity: The ongoing high-speed broadband rollout currently reaching **1.1 million people.**

Physical Tech Hubs: Continued expansion of the National Hub Network and National Hub Strategy to provide professional remote-working environments outside major cities.

Regulatory Digitization: A directive for the Workplace Relations Commission *(WRC)* to strengthen the Code of Practice, providing clearer digital templates, guidance, and transparent decision-making timelines for employers and employees.

Financial Incentives: Maintaining specific tax reliefs for home-based work to offset the costs of private digital office setups.

Ireland's 2026 review demonstrates that the "Right to Request" is no longer just a social policy but a foundational pillar of its **national digital labor strategy**. By achieving a near-universal approval rate for remote work, Ireland is effectively decentralizing its tech economy, moving high-value IT and professional roles into rural areas to alleviate urban congestion. This approach, supported by a massive 1.1-million-person broadband expansion, positions the country to attract and retain elite global tech talent that increasingly demands "work-from-anywhere" flexibility as a standard employment condition.

(Read full article at https://enterprise.gov.ie/en/news-and-events/department-news/2026/march/20260305.html#:~:text=The%20comprehensive%20review%20shows%20that,the%20review%20of%20the%20legislation%3A)

9. Canada launches $ 900M defense tech investment to boost Quantum, Drone, and IT innovation

(Government of Ganada)

On March 9, 2026, the Canadian government announced a sweeping $ 900 million investment through the National Research Council to support its Defence Industrial Strategy, placing a heavy emphasis on next-generation technology, IT infrastructure, and autonomous systems. As part of a massive $ 500 million allocation toward aerospace and autonomous capabilities, Canada is establishing a dedicated Drone Innovation Hub in Ottawa and Mirabel to accelerate both commercial and military drone and counter-drone technologies, alongside acquiring a new Bombardier defense research aircraft. To cultivate the domestic technology ecosystem, the government also launched the $ 241 million Defence Industry Assist initiative to fund small and medium-sized enterprises scaling dual-use tech and IT manufacturing capabilities. Furthermore, an injection of over $ 161 million is specifically targeted at securing Canada's leadership in quantum computing and cybersecurity. This strategic push includes expanding semiconductor fabrication facilities to secure domestic hardware supply chains, advancing the Quantum Internetworking Challenge for distributed computing, and launching the Quantum Safe Technologies Initiative to aggressively prepare Canadian digital infrastructure for post-quantum cryptographic algorithms.

Canada is aggressively pivoting its defense posture to prioritize advanced digital sovereignty, recognizing that future security relies heavily on quantum computing, deep tech, and autonomous systems. By injecting nearly, a billion dollars into dual-use tech startups, drone innovation, and post-quantum cryptographic networks in a cohesive funding pipeline, the government is simultaneously hardening its military capabilities and directly subsidizing its commercial IT sector. This integrated approach ensures that Canadian tech enterprises remain highly competitive, resilient, and fully interoperable within the rapidly evolving technological landscape of the broader NATO alliance.

(Read full article at https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2026/03/canada-advances-defence-industrial-strategy-to-strengthen-security-sovereignty-and-prosperity.html)

10. Nvidia backs AI data center startup Nscale as it hits $ 14.6 billion valuation

(CNBC)

UK-based AI cloud startup Nscale has secured a massive $ 2 billion Series C funding round, catapulting its valuation to $ 14.6 billion. The round, reportedly the largest Series C in European history, was led by Aker ASA and 8090 Industries, with participation from major tech heavyweights including Nvidia, Dell, Lenovo, and Nokia. Founded just two years ago as a spinoff from a cryptocurrency mining operation, Nscale develops vertically integrated, purpose-built AI data centers across North America and Europe, including highly specialized liquid-cooled and seawater-cooled facilities. Alongside the funding, Nscale is consolidating its joint ventures and bringing high-profile veterans onto its board, including former Meta executives Sheryl Sandberg and Nick Clegg, and former Yahoo president Susan Decker. The fresh capital will be used to accelerate the global deployment of its GPU compute capabilities to meet skyrocketing demand from clients like Microsoft and OpenAI.

This landmark funding round underscores the sheer scale of the global arms race to build dedicated physical infrastructure for artificial intelligence. By securing both massive capital and direct backing from hardware giant Nvidia, Nscale is rapidly positioning itself as a dominant "neocloud" operator, proving that the critical bottleneck in the AI revolution is no longer just software innovation, but the ability to quickly deploy and reliably power massive, highly efficient computing facilities. Furthermore, the strategic addition of seasoned tech executives to its board signals that Nscale is aggressively laying the groundwork and establishing the governance required for a potential high-profile IPO in the near future.

(Read full article at https://www.cnbc.com/2026/03/09/nscale-ai-data-center-nvidia-raise.html)

11. OpenAI to buy cybersecurity startup Promptfoo to better safeguard AI agents

(CNBC)

On March 9, 2026, OpenAI announced the acquisition of the cybersecurity startup Promptfoo to enhance the security, governance, and compliance of its autonomous AI agents. Promptfoo specializes in open-source automated red-teaming and security testing tools, which are already utilized by over 125,000 developers and more than 30 Fortune 500 companies to evaluate large language models. While the financial terms of the deal were not disclosed *(Promptfoo was last valued at $ 85.5 million in 2025)*, Promptfoo's team, including CEO Ian Webster, will join OpenAI. The startup's technology will be directly integrated into OpenAI's Frontier platform to protect AI agents from adversarial threats as they connect to real-world data and production systems. OpenAI also confirmed that it will continue to support and develop Promptfoo's open-source project.

OpenAI's acquisition of Promptfoo underscores a critical strategic shift toward enterprise-grade AI application security. As generative AI transitions from simple chatbots to autonomous agents executing tasks in live production environments, the cybersecurity attack surface expands significantly. By bringing a leading, developer-trusted red-teaming tool in-house, OpenAI is proactively addressing the complex governance risks of agentic AI, reassuring its corporate clientele, and directly answering similar enterprise security moves made by competitors like Anthropic.

(Read full article at https://www.cnbc.com/2026/03/09/open-ai-cybersecurity-promptfoo-ai-agents.html)

12. Anthropic was the Pentagon's choice for AI. Now it's banned and experts are worried

(CNBC)

In July 2025, the AI startup Anthropic secured a $ 200 million contract with the U.S. Department of Defense *(DOD)*, becoming the first company to deploy its AI models *(Claude)* within the Pentagon's classified networks, aided by partnerships with Amazon Web Services and Palantir. However, the relationship collapsed under the new Trump administration due to a standoff over ethical guardrails. The DOD demanded unrestricted access to the technology for all legal military purposes, while Anthropic insisted on strict assurances that its models would not be used for fully autonomous weapons or domestic mass surveillance.

Consequently, the Pentagon took the unprecedented step of blacklisting the American firm, officially designating Anthropic as a "supply chain risk to national security" – a punitive label typically reserved for foreign adversaries. This forced defense contractor to immediately begin purging Claude from their systems. On March 9, 2026, Anthropic retaliated by filing federal lawsuits against the Trump administration to block the ban, citing political retaliation and warning of irreparable harm, including the loss of hundreds of millions of dollars in revenue. While commercial partners like Google, Microsoft, and Amazon have confirmed they will continue offering Anthropic's AI to non-defense clients, experts warn the ban creates massive instability in the sector.

The Pentagon's blacklisting of Anthropic marks a drastic escalation in the ideological and ethical battle over military AI adoption. By labeling a leading domestic AI developer as a national security threat simply because the company refused to remove safety guardrails against autonomous weaponry, the administration is sending a clear message: it will not tolerate corporate restrictions on U.S. military capabilities. This unprecedented move not only threatens Anthropic's immediate financial viability in the defense sector but also sets a chilling precedent for the broader tech industry, signaling that lucrative government partnerships will increasingly demand absolute compliance with military objectives over corporate ethical standards.

(Read full article at https://www.cnbc.com/2026/03/09/anthropic-was-the-pentagons-choice-for-ai-now-its-banned-and-experts-are-worried.html)

13. OpenAI moves to build a proprietary ad tech ecosystem for ChatGPT

(Digiday)

OpenAI is actively laying the groundwork to build its own proprietary advertising technology stack, signaling a strategic shift away from permanent reliance on third-party vendors. While the company currently leans on partners like Criteo, and is reportedly in talks with The Trade Desk, to rapidly monetize the 95% of its 910 million weekly ChatGPT users who do not pay for subscriptions, internal hiring indicates these partnerships are a temporary "means to an end." OpenAI is aggressively recruiting full-time engineering managers, product designers, and a monetization infrastructure engineer *(offering compensation up to $ 385,000)* to construct an internal, customized ad system from the ground up. Industry analysts note that an in-house stack is essential for OpenAI to execute its vision of a "new kind of advertising" based directly on conversational AI intent rather than traditional demographic targeting, while also maintaining strict control over privacy and user trust.

OpenAI is executing a classic tech-industry playbook: renting infrastructure to gain immediate revenue while quietly building the internal machinery required to eventually own the entire ecosystem. By investing heavily in its own monetization engineering and ad tech infrastructure, OpenAI aims to transform ChatGPT from a subsidized AI tool into a self-sustaining, closed-loop advertising platform, fundamentally disrupting the traditional programmatic ad tech market and potentially bypassing the very third-party DSPs it currently relies on.

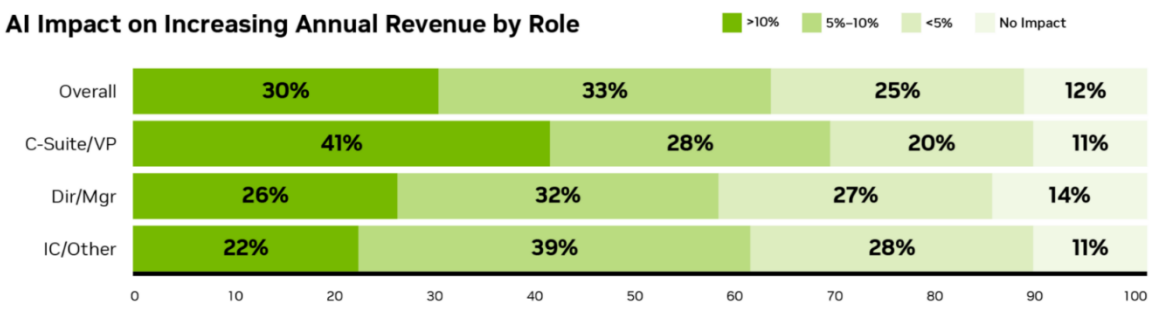
(Read full article at https://digiday.com/media-buying/openai-is-b-building-the-ad-tech-stack-its-currently-borrowing/)

ANALYSIS

14. How AI is driving revenue, cutting costs and boosting productivity for every industry in 2026

(Blogs.nvidia)

Based on NVIDIA's 2026 State of AI Report, the landscape of enterprise artificial intelligence has definitively matured from a phase of exploration and pilot programs into scaled, active deployment across industries. The survey of over 3,200 global professionals



reveals a strong pulse of AI adoption, with 64% of organizations now actively integrating AI into their operations. This adoption is notably stratified by company size and geography. Large enterprises with over 1,000 employees are at the forefront, with 76% reporting active usage, largely due to their capacity to invest in necessary infrastructure and specialized talent. Geographically, North America leads the charge with a 70% active adoption rate, closely followed by the EMEA and APAC regions.

The primary drivers and tangible impacts of this widespread integration center around operational efficiency, productivity, and financial optimization. Organizations are increasingly looking to AI not just as a novel technology, but as a core utility to drive tangible business outcomes. A staggering 88% of respondents report that AI has successfully increased their annual revenue, while 87% confirm it has driven down annual costs. The impacts on employee productivity are equally profound. By utilizing tools like digital twins in manufacturing or streamlining financial market analysis, over half of the surveyed enterprises noted improved employee productivity as a primary benefit. This enhanced efficiency is creating cascading effects, opening up new business opportunities and revenue streams that were previously inaccessible.

A significant technological evolution highlighted in the 2026 report is the rapid ascent of agentic AI and the continued dominance of open-source strategies. Following an experimentation phase in 2025, agentic AI, advanced systems capable of autonomously reasoning, planning, and executing complex tasks, has seen full-fledged deployments in early 2026, particularly in telecommunications and retail. Meanwhile, the foundation of these highly specific and profitable AI applications relies heavily on open-source and open-weight models. An overwhelming 85% of respondents consider open-source tools moderately to extremely important to their AI strategy, allowing them to fine-tune models with proprietary data without relying solely on commercial off-the-shelf products. Data analytics and generative AI currently stand neck-and-neck as the top workloads across all sectors.

Despite the immense momentum and the fact that 86% of organizations plan to increase their AI budgets this year, substantial hurdles remain. The most prominent challenges revolve around data management and human capital. Nearly half of the respondents cited having sufficient data and managing data-related issues as their primary obstacle in building specialized applications. Furthermore, 38% of organizations struggle with a lack of AI experts and data scientists required to scale projects from pilot to production. Additionally, quantifying the exact return on investment for subjective metrics like office worker productivity remains a challenge for nearly a third of executives, indicating that while the overarching financial benefits are clear, granular measurement requires further refinement.

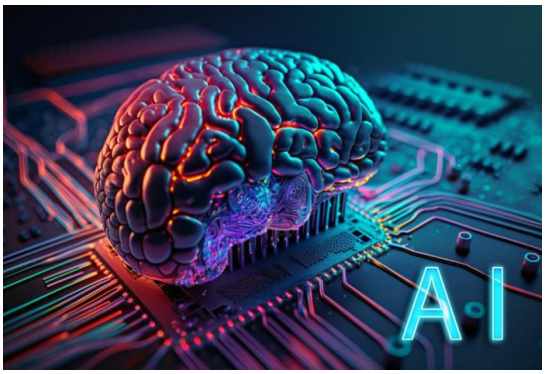
Enterprise AI has officially transitioned from experimental pilots to widespread, profitable deployment. Powered by open-source tools and the rapid rise of autonomous agentic AI, organizations are seeing definitive, measurable gains in revenue, cost reduction, and employee productivity. While significant hurdles remain – specifically regarding data management and a global shortage of AI talent – the overwhelming trend points toward continued, aggressive investment as AI cements itself as a fundamental driver of modern business operations.

(Read full article at https://blogs.nvidia.com/blog/state-of-ai-report-2026/)

15. Has AI ended thought leadership?

(Harvard Business Review)

The proliferation of generative artificial intelligence has fundamentally altered the landscape of professional discourse, challenging the very definition and value of traditional "thought leadership." Historically, producing high-quality, authoritative content served as a reliable signal of a professional's expertise and industry standing. However, **the advent of sophisticated AI models has dramatically lowered the barrier to entry, making it easier than ever for anyone to generate polished, expert-sounding articles, white papers, and insights at scale**. This rapid democratization of content creation has inadvertently commoditized conventional thought leadership, flooding digital platforms with synthesized information that, while highly articulate, often lacks genuine depth, original perspective, or real-world friction.



Consequently, the focus of audience trust and professional influence is rapidly shifting away from those who merely curate or articulate industry trends toward individuals with verifiable, lived experience. Because AI excels at aggregating and mimicking existing knowledge, the premium in today's market is now placed on the un-synthesizable elements of leadership: **hard-won lessons from operational failures, nuanced situational judgment, and deep, experiential wisdom**. This deluge of AI-generated content is forcing a necessary correction in how audiences and organizations evaluate authority. It demands that true thought leaders move beyond simply sounding like experts and instead offer authentic, human-centric narratives rooted in the messy, practical realities of their work.

While AI has not entirely eliminated thought leadership, it has effectively killed its superficial, content-driven iteration. By commoditizing polished, expert-sounding text, generative AI has shifted the true measure of authority away from the mere ability to articulate ideas, demanding instead that leaders rely on their verifiable, lived professional experience to build genuine trust and influence.

(Read full article at https://hbr.org/2026/03/has-ai-ended-thought-leadership)

Events calendar for IT PARK UZBEKISTAN, RESIDENTS OF IT PARK UZBEKISTAN and MINISTRY OF DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES – *(March 2026)*

IT PARK UZBEKISTAN					
Date	**Event name**	**Description**	**Location**	**Event holder**	**Official Website**
Mar 16	Exploration of applied competencies	Regional integration workshop with EU universities to bridge knowledge gaps in the Central Asian talent pool.	Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan *(Hybrid)*	Digitech	digitech.kg
Mar 17	Sourcing Spotlight on India	BME webinar exploring global procurement corridors, helping IT Park map competition and partnership routes.	Germany *(Online)*	BME Matchmaking	bmematchmaking.com
Mar 17-19	Union of Industrialists & Entrepreneurs Expo	Strategic exhibition in Ashgabat. IT Park can promote its "Local2Global" expansion initiatives to Turkmen businesses.	Ashgabat, Turkmenistan *(Offline)*	Chamber of Commerce	turkmenistaninfo.gov.tm
Mar 23-26	Kube Con 2026	Cloud Native flagship event. IT Park infrastructure managers can explore edge-computing tech for local data centers.	Amsterdam *(Online)*	CNCF	nebius.com
Mar 24	Sourcing Social: Service Provider User Group	GSA UK session. IT Park leadership engages with UK buyers to shape the "Emerging Locations" outsourcing narrative.	UK *(Online)*	GSA UK	gsa-uk.com
Mar 24-25	Free CX Network Webinar Series	Valuable strategic intelligence on how global brands are shifting their customer experience outsourcing budgets.	Online	CX Network	cxnetwork.com
Mar 25-27	AgroWorld Uzbekistan 2026	Major domestic expo. IT Park uses this to connect resident AgTech startups with traditional	Tashkent, Uzbekistan *(Offline)*	Iteca Exhibitions	iteca.uz

		agricultural conglomerates.			
Mar 26	Turkmenistan-EU Business Forum 2026	High-level trade forum. IT Park can observe EU digital trade policies extending into the Caspian/Central Asian corridor.	Ashgabat, Turkmenistan *(Offline)*	Int'l Trade Centre	intracen.org
RESIDENTS OF IT PARK UZBEKISTAN					
Date	**Event name**	**Description**	**Location**	**Event holder**	**Official Website**
Mar 10	Production-Ready Agents	A Google Cloud workshop on scaling autonomous AI agents using MCP servers.	Online	Google Cloud	cloudonair.withgoogle.com
Mar 10	Science, Technology, Engineering and Management	A cross-disciplinary forum for discovering applied tech solutions in the Caucasus market.	Baku, Azerbaijan *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	allconferencealert.com
Mar 11	KSUG.AI APAC online Meetup	Online meetup focusing on AI applications and data engineering networking in the APAC and CIS time zones.	Online	KSUG.AI	dev.events
Mar 11	AI Runs on Open Source	Linux Foundation session on leveraging open-source tools for robust AI architectures.	Online	Linux Foundation	linuxfoundation.org
Mar 11	Coordinating Secure GPU-Accelerated Agents	Microsoft Reactor lab covering Foundry Control Plane orchestration for advanced Azure AI.	Online	Microsoft Reactor	developer.microsoft.com
Mar 11	Blockchain & Cybersecurity in Big Data	Explores cryptography in high-volume data environments, essential for fintech residents.	Osh, Kyrgyzstan *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	internationalconferencealerts.com
Mar 12	Microsoft Azure Summit: Migrate with Agentic AI	Explores reducing operational complexity by deploying agentic solutions during cloud migrations.	Online	Microsoft	microsoft.com/events

Mar 12-13	Virtual Training Day: Azure Fundamentals	Foundational cloud concepts, cost optimization, and security protocols essential for BPO residents serving Western clients.	Online	Microsoft Azure	microsoft.com/events
Mar 15-16	Virtual Training: Implement Data Security with Purview	Learn to build targeted data loss protection measures with Microsoft Purview to ensure GDPR/CCPA compliance for export work.	Online	Microsoft Security	microsoft.com/events
Mar 16-17	Virtual Training: Create Agents in Copilot Studio	Learn to build and deploy custom AI agents in Copilot Studio to automate workflows and elevate SaaS offerings.	Online	Microsoft	microsoft.com/events
Mar 17	Context Engineering for Self-Healing AI SRE	Advanced SRE methodologies utilizing AI to auto-correct infrastructure faults.	Online	Linux Foundation	linuxfoundation.org
Mar 18	Practical Approaches to Interoperable Blockchain	Discusses cross-chain compatibility and smart contract engineering.	Online	Linux Foundation	linuxfoundation.org
Mar 19	Build Agentic AI Solutions (Session 1)	Microsoft training on Semantic Kernel Agent Framework and Azure AI Foundry.	Online	Microsoft	microsoft.com/events
Mar 19	Predictive Analytics & ML Models	Academic and applied deep dive into predictive data modeling algorithms.	Osh, Kyrgyzstan *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	internationalconferencealerts.com
Mar 21	World Congress on IT and Computer Science	A broad technical congress allowing developers to benchmark against global engineering standards.	Brest, Belarus *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	conferenceineurope.org
Mar 22	Build Agentic AI Solutions (Session 2)	Second session for developers to master custom AI agent generation on Azure.	Online	Microsoft	microsoft.com/events
Mar 23	Blockchain and AI in International Business	AIB webinar investigating how these	Online	AIB	aib.world

		technologies are applied practically by global firms.			
Mar 24	What's New: Connected ERP for Private Capital	Carta webinar analyzing backend financial tech systems and SaaS tools for venture capital.	Online	Carta	carta.com
Mar 25	Is your startup ready for fundraising?	Swiss Startup Association webinar teaching founders how to use AI to improve pitch metrics.	Online	Swiss Startup Assoc	swissstartupassociation.ch
Mar 26	betterCode() Clean Architecture 2026	Intensive software engineering conference focusing on maintainable, scalable codebases.	Online	IT Community	dev.events
Mar 26	Automating the Middle Office	Driving Digital Transformation in the Middle Office, exploring the data gap between assets for finance-oriented startups.	Online	Carta	carta.com
Mar 26-27	Node Congress	A massive virtual gathering for backend developers building scalable apps with Node.js.	Online	IT Community	dev.events
Mar 27	Smart Manufacturing Systems using Blockchain	Niche event for residents building industrial IoT and supply chain tracking software.	Baku, Azerbaijan *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	internationalconferencealerts.com
MINISTRY OF DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES					
Date	**Event name**	**Description**	**Location**	**Event holder**	**Official Website**
Mar 10	Flexible Tech Strategies for Uncertain Terrain	A session for government leaders on agile IT procurement and maintaining resilient digital services.	USA *(Online)*	GovTech	webinars.govtech.com
Mar 11	International Conference on Big	Focuses on cloud-based geographic information systems, crucial for	Samarkand, Uzbekistan *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	conferencealerts.co.in

	Data Integration with GIS	updating Uzbekistan's digital land registry and spatial infrastructure.			
Mar 11	Rebuilding from Disaster with Technology	Examines how digital tools assess damage and coordinate state responses during natural crises.	USA *(Online)*	GovTech	webinars.govtech.com
Mar 12	ENISA Cybersecurity Standardisation Conference	Focuses on the European AI Act and Data Act, vital for the Ministry aligning Uzbek cyber laws with EU standards.	Brussels, Belgium *(Hybrid)*	ENISA	enisa.europa.eu
Mar 12	Industry Insider – California Member Briefing	Briefing on state-level digital modernization projects, offering blueprints for Uzbekistan's e-Gov systems.	USA *(Online)*	GovTech	events.govtech.com
Mar 19	Georgia Public Sector Cybersecurity Summit	Interactive sessions on building cyber-resilient organizations and protecting state data.	Atlanta, USA *(Offline)*	GovTech	events.govtech.com
Mar 19	Int'l Conf on GIS in Disaster Management	Discusses tech-driven risk reduction, highly relevant to the Ministry's Smart Nation initiatives.	Tashkent, Uzbekistan *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	conferencealerts.co.in
Mar 19	Spatial Data Infrastructure and Policy	Armenian summit on data policy, beneficial for harmonizing Central Asian data exchange systems.	Gyumri, Armenia *(Hybrid)*	Conference Alerts	conferencealerts.co.in
Mar 25	Fight Fraud, Waste and Abuse with AI	GovTech webinar demonstrating AI applications for auditing and securing public funds.	USA *(Online)*	GovTech	webinars.govtech.com
Mar 25-26	Government Efficiency Summit 2026	Explores the intersection of automation, AI, and streamlined government operations.	USA *(Online)*	GovTech	events.govtech.com

Mar 25	North Carolina AI and Cybersecurity Symposium	Investigates policy overlaps between AI adoption and national security protocols.	Raleigh, USA *(Offline)*	GovTech	events.govtech.com
Mar 25-26	Tashkent Water Week 2026	A sector-specific event where the Ministry can explore IoT and digital monitoring for water resource management.	Tashkent, Uzbekistan *(Offline)*	Iteca Exhibitions	iteca.uz
Mar 26	Eligibility Decisions You Can Defend	Explores how AI-assisted systems improve accuracy and oversight in citizen service determinations.	USA *(Online)*	GovTech	webinars.govtech.com
Mar 26	Securing the Cyber/Software Supply Chain	Virtual workshop equipping government officials to safeguard IT procurement and software assets.	USA *(Online)*	Digital Government Institute	digitalgovernment.com